1. **Layered client–server architecture**
    a. Our team considered keeping the app's interface, logic, and data access together, or separating them into a mobile app, backend, and database. We chose separate layers, with the backend handling requests and rules and being the only part that accesses the database. This makes it easier for us to work on different parts and apply review limits consistently. The tradeoff is that we have more components to build and connect, but this structure supports shared bathroom information and ratings as the app grows.
2. **Observer pattern for rating updates**
    a. We considered having each screen fetch updates on its own or having one large component manage every view. Instead, we plan to use a shared `BathroomStore` that receives rating updates and notifies the map, bathroom list, and detail panel. This lets each view update independently and keeps us from opening a separate realtime connection for every view. The tradeoff is that we need to build and maintain the shared store, but it will be easier to add views later.
3. **Map provider adapter**
    a. We considered Apple MapKit and Google Maps Platform, but we haven't chosen the provider yet. Our plan is to connect whichever provider we select through a `Map Provider Adapter`, so the map view can request maps and directions through one consistent interface. The tradeoff is that building the adapter adds some work now, but it gives our team flexibility while we decide which provider best fits the project.